Chapter-wise Detailed Notes — Panchayati Raj Institutions

Indian Government & Politics · Unit 5 · Chapter Panchayati Raj Institutions

Assam University · BA FYUGP / NEP 2020 · Semester 1

Chapter Study Notes

Learning focus

The 73rd Constitutional Amendment established a constitutional framework for rural local government through Part IX and the Eleventh Schedule.

1. Panchayati Raj institutions commonly include village, intermediate and district levels, subject to constitutional provisions and state-specific arrangements.

2. The Gram Sabha provides a forum for village-level participation. Elections, reservations and State Finance Commissions are important parts of the framework.

3. Local institutions can improve responsiveness and participation but may face limited revenue, staff shortages, elite capture and overlapping responsibilities.

4. Actual devolution of functions, funds and functionaries depends substantially on state legislation and implementation.

Revision checklist

■ Can I define the key concept in my own words?

■ Can I explain its main features and distinguish it from related concepts?

■ Can I support an argument with a relevant example, thinker or constitutional provision?

■ Can I discuss at least one limitation or counterargument?